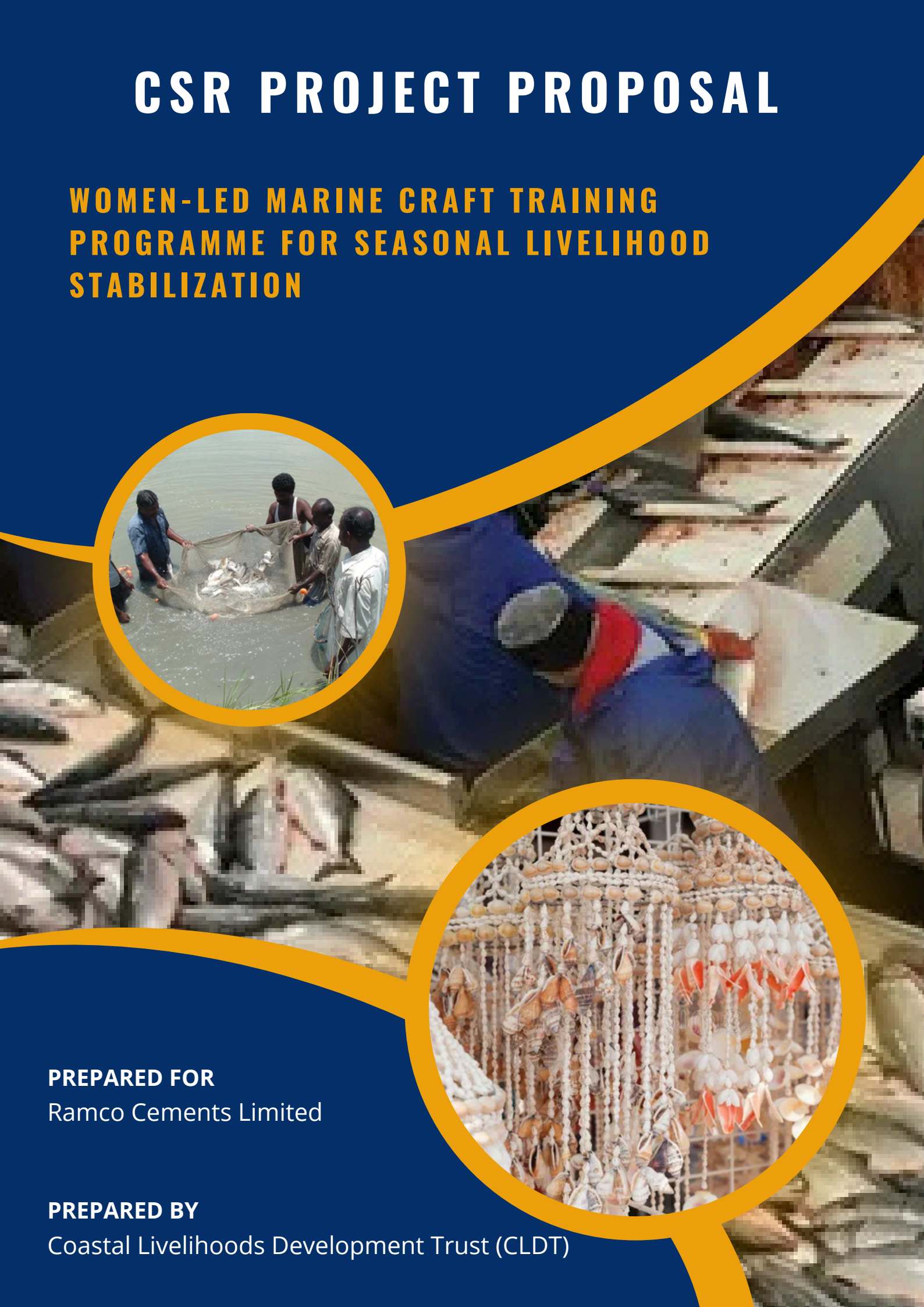
CSR PROJECT PROPOSAL

WOMEN-LED MARINE CRAFT TRAINING PROGRAMME FOR SEASONAL LIVELIHOOD STABILIZATION



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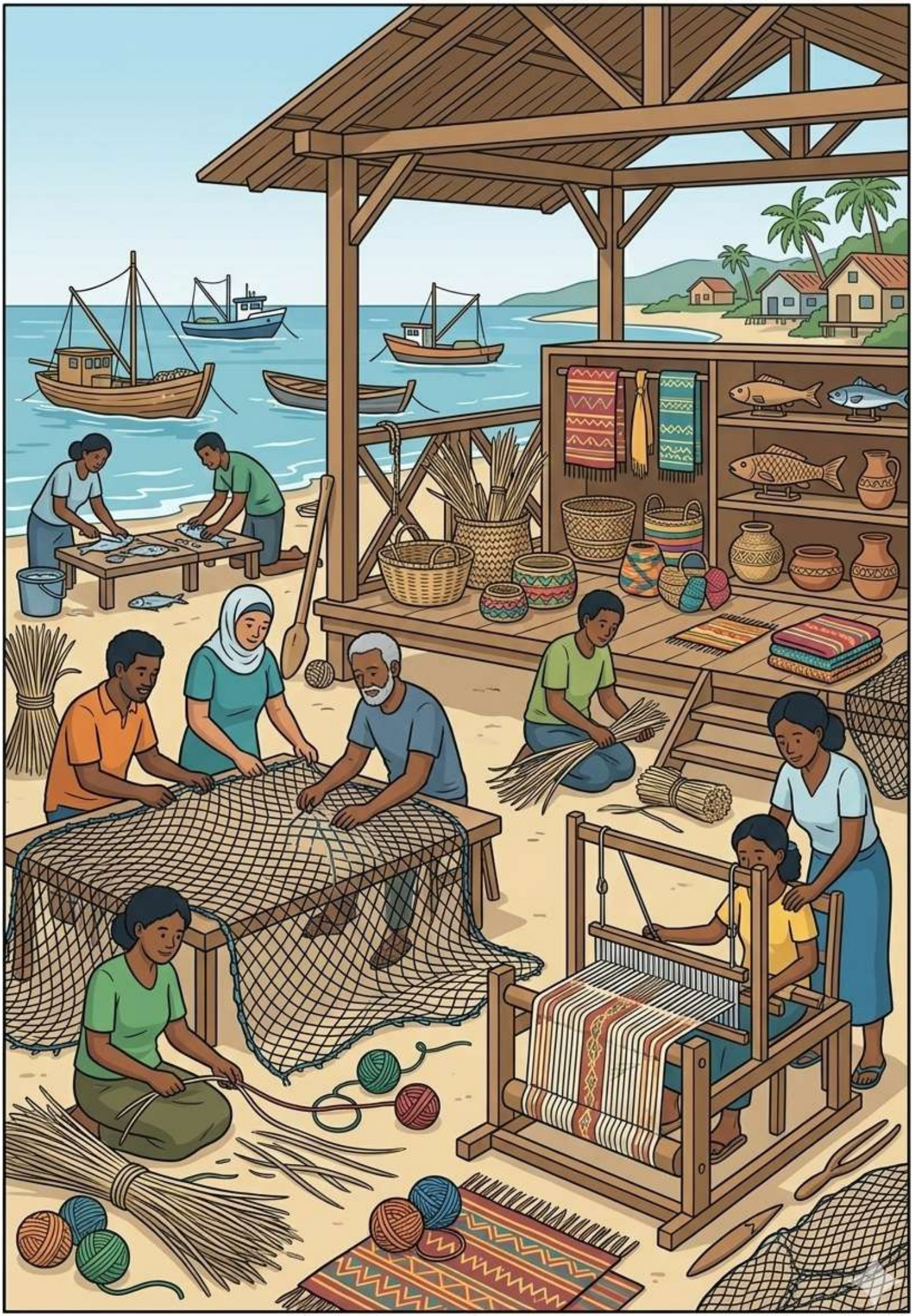

CSR PROJECT PROPOSAL

Women-Led Marine Craft Enterprise Programme for Seasonal Livelihood Stabilization

Location: Colachel Fishing Village, Kalkulam Taluk, Kanyakumari District, Tamil Nadu

Project Duration

April 15, 2026 – June 14, 2027
(14 Months – One Full Fishing Ban Cycle)

Target Beneficiaries

300 Women from Fishing-Dependent Households

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1. About Us

Coastal Livelihoods Development Trust (CLDT) is a registered Public Charitable Trust with more than a decade of experience in coastal livelihood development across Tamil Nadu. The organization works with fishing communities on livelihood diversification, marine safety awareness, and post-harvest management initiatives.

CLDT holds valid 12A and 80G registrations under the Income Tax Act and is duly registered under CSR-1, making it eligible to implement Corporate Social Responsibility projects under the Companies Act, 2013. The organization maintains active PAN and TAN registrations, and its audited financial statements for the past three financial years are available for due diligence.

CLDT does not receive foreign contributions and therefore does not operate under the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA). The governing board consists of seven members, including a marine science expert and a retired Fisheries Department officer, ensuring technical guidance and administrative oversight.

The organization has previously collaborated with the Tamil Nadu Department of Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare and local fisher cooperatives in implementing community-level capacity building initiatives and livelihood programs in coastal regions.

2. Project Problem Statement and Rationale

Tamil Nadu enforces an annual 61-day mechanized fishing ban from April 15 to June 14 along the east coast to allow marine fish stocks to regenerate during peak breeding season. While this measure is critical for ecological sustainability, it creates significant seasonal economic disruption for fishing-dependent households.

According to the Marine Fisheries Census (2016), Kanyakumari district contains:

- 39 marine fishing villages
- Approximately 39,402 marine fishing families

Fishing households experience severe liquidity stress during the ban period due to the sudden loss of fishing income. The impacts extend beyond mechanized vessel crews and affect the broader coastal economy.

Direct Economic Impact

- Wage loss among mechanized fishing crew members
- Vessel repair and maintenance costs during the ban period

Indirect Economic Impact

- Reduced fish availability affecting women vendors
- Decline in fish processing and market activity
- Reduction in harbour-based wage labour opportunities
- Increased dependence on informal credit sources

Even households above the official poverty line frequently experience temporary income collapse during the ban period due to their dependence on seasonal fishing income.

Women in fishing households often bear the burden of managing household consumption and debt during this period. However, they have limited access to structured livelihood opportunities that could provide alternative income during seasonal fishing closures.

This project proposes to develop women-led marine craft enterprises using discarded marine materials, providing a locally relevant and environmentally responsible livelihood option that can generate income during the fishing ban period.

The initiative draws inspiration from coastal craft clusters developed in Ganjam district of Odisha, where discarded fishing nets and marine materials have been successfully converted into marketable handicrafts.

3. Target Group and Beneficiary Identification

The project will target 300 women from fishing-dependent households in Colachel Fishing Village. Beneficiaries will be selected through a structured Ban Vulnerability Index (BVI) designed to identify households experiencing the highest seasonal income instability.

Each household will be assessed against the following criteria:

1. Primary household income dependent on fishing activities
2. No alternative income source during fishing ban period
3. Outstanding informal household debt exceeding ₹50,000
4. No salaried family member in the household
5. Women engaged in informal fish vending or fish-related work
6. Household dependent on wage-based fishing crew employment

Each criterion will be scored as 1 point, creating a score range from 0 to 6. Households scoring 4 or above will be prioritized for programme inclusion. This approach ensures that the intervention reaches households experiencing structural seasonal vulnerability rather than relying solely on official poverty classifications.

4. Beneficiary Selection Process

To ensure transparency and community acceptance, the following selection procedure will be adopted:

1. Public announcement of the programme at the harbour and village level
2. Submission of beneficiary application forms
3. Vulnerability scoring conducted by the NGO project team
4. Verification with a representative from the local fisher cooperative

5. Publication of a provisional beneficiary list
6. Seven-day public review and grievance window
7. Finalization of the beneficiary list

All documentation will be maintained for transparency and audit purposes.

5. Project Components

Component 1 : Marine Waste and Coastal Craft Enterprise Training

This component will provide structured training to selected women beneficiaries in producing marketable craft products using discarded marine materials such as fishing nets, ropes, and shells.

Training Structure

- 12 training batches
- 25 participants per batch
- Practical, skill-based training modules, Hands-on product development workshops.
- Product finishing and quality improvement sessions
- Packaging and tourist-market presentation training
- Optional craft skill certification support

Training Modules

Participants will be trained in:

- Net weaving for baskets and utility products
- Rope-based home décor items
- Shell jewellery and coastal souvenir products
- Marine-themed handicrafts and accessories
- Product finishing and quality control techniques
- Packaging and presentation for tourist markets

Proposed Technical Partners

Training support may be sourced from:

- Trainers empanelled under Tamil Nadu State Rural Livelihood Mission (TNSRLM)
- Local handicraft artisans experienced in recycled material crafts
- Resource persons from the District Industries Centre (DIC)
- Advisory support from the Tamil Nadu Department of Fisheries and Fishermen Welfare

Expected Outputs

- 300 women trained in marine craft production
- Increased household income diversification
- Reduced dependence on high-interest informal loans
- Increased seasonal livelihood options during fishing ban period

Component 2 : Monitoring, Evaluation and Impact Assessment

A structured monitoring and evaluation framework will be implemented to track programme performance and outcomes.

Phase 1 – Baseline Assessment (April 15 – June 14, 2026)

Activities include:

- Household socio-economic survey
- Income and debt profiling
- Ban Vulnerability Index scoring
- Beneficiary verification

Phase 2 – Implementation Monitoring (June 15, 2026 – April 14, 2027)

Activities include:

- Training session monitoring
- Participant attendance tracking
- Production activity monitoring
- Quarterly beneficiary review meetings

Phase 3 – Endline Evaluation (April 15 – June 14, 2027)

Activities include:

- Income tracking during subsequent fishing ban period
- Debt reduction comparison with baseline data
- Beneficiary interviews and case studies
- Final impact assessment report

6. Implementation Timeline

Phase	Timeline	Key Activities
Phase 1	Apr 15 – Jun 14 2026	Baseline assessment and beneficiary selection
Phase 2	Jun 15 2026 – Apr 14 2027	Training implementation and monitoring
Phase 3	Apr 15 – Jun 14 2027	Endline evaluation and impact assessment

7. Risk and Compliance Safeguards

Key safeguards include:

- Transparent beneficiary selection process
- Proper documentation of training delivery
- Transparent procurement procedures
- No direct cash transfers to beneficiaries
- Independent financial audit of project expenditure
- Aligning with the Tamil Nadu Tourism Policy, which seeks to promote local handicrafts at major coastal hubs like Mamallapuram, Dhanushkodi, and Kanyakumari.
- Udyam Registration
- Geographical Indication (GI) Awareness: If the shell craft is specific to a region (like Thoothukudi), training on GI tags could add value.
- E-commerce Integration: Mentioning training for Government e-Marketplace (GeM) or the "Mathi" (TNSRLM) e-portal would be highly relevant for modern market access.

8. Sustainability Strategy

The project promotes low-cost, home-based craft training that can continue beyond the project period.

Sustainability will be supported through:

- Formation of Self-Help Group production clusters if necessary
- Market linkage with tourism outlets in Kanyakumari
- Community-led continuation of craft production
- Integration with government livelihood programmes where possible
- Identification of local tourist markets in Kanyakumari town and Colachel
- Linking SHG craft groups to tourism souvenir shops if necessary
- Participation in district handicraft exhibitions
- Development of simple product catalogues
- Facilitating connections with local retailers and church festival markets

Expected Outcomes:

- Market access for craft products
- Increased sales opportunities
- Sustained production beyond project period

9. Certification and Institutional Facilitation

Marine craft products produced under this project are handmade handicraft items, and therefore no mandatory government production licence is required for individual artisans producing at small scale.

However, to strengthen the credibility of the training and provide participants with formal recognition of skills acquired, the project will facilitate optional skill certification and artisan recognition mechanisms where feasible.

The following institutional linkages may be facilitated:

Skill Certification

Participants completing the training programme may receive a skill completion certificate issued by the implementing organization and trainers documenting:

- craft skill modules completed
- number of training hours
- product categories learned

Where feasible, the project may explore alignment with the Skill India ecosystem through the Handicrafts and Carpet Sector Skill Council (HCSSC) under the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship.

This would allow participants to obtain nationally recognised skill certification for handicraft production through accredited training partners.

Artisan Identity Registration (Optional)

Participants interested in formal recognition as artisans may be supported to apply for the Artisan Identity Card (Pehchan Card) issued by the Office of the Development Commissioner (Handicrafts), Ministry of Textiles, Government of India.

The Pehchan card provides:

- official artisan identity recognition
- eligibility to participate in national handicraft exhibitions
- access to government artisan welfare schemes.

Market Readiness Support

Participants will receive guidance on:

- product packaging and presentation
- pricing and small-scale craft sales
- participation in local tourism markets in Kanyakumari district.

No mandatory business registration will be required during the project phase, ensuring that the craft activity remains low-barrier and home-based.

10. Results Chain

The project follows a **Results-Based Management (RBM) framework**.

Inputs	Activities	Outputs	Outcomes	Impact
•Training resources •Trainers and technical experts •Training materials and tools •Monitoring staff •Project management support	•Beneficiary selection •Craft training workshops •Packaging and branding sessions •Monitoring visits •Endline evaluation	•300 women trained •12 training workshops conducted •Followup when needed •Craft products developed and marketed	•Increased seasonal income opportunities •Reduced dependence on informal loans	•Improved livelihood stability during fishing ban periods.

11. Budget Framework

Budget summary is as follows

S.No	Budget Component	Cost
1	Project Mobilization & Beneficiary Selection	₹1,75,000
2	Training Programme	₹6,47,000
3	Training Kits for Participants	₹2,40,000
4	Raw Materials for Training	₹2,10,000
5	Temporary Training Workspace	₹90,000
6	Participant Support Costs	₹4,50,000

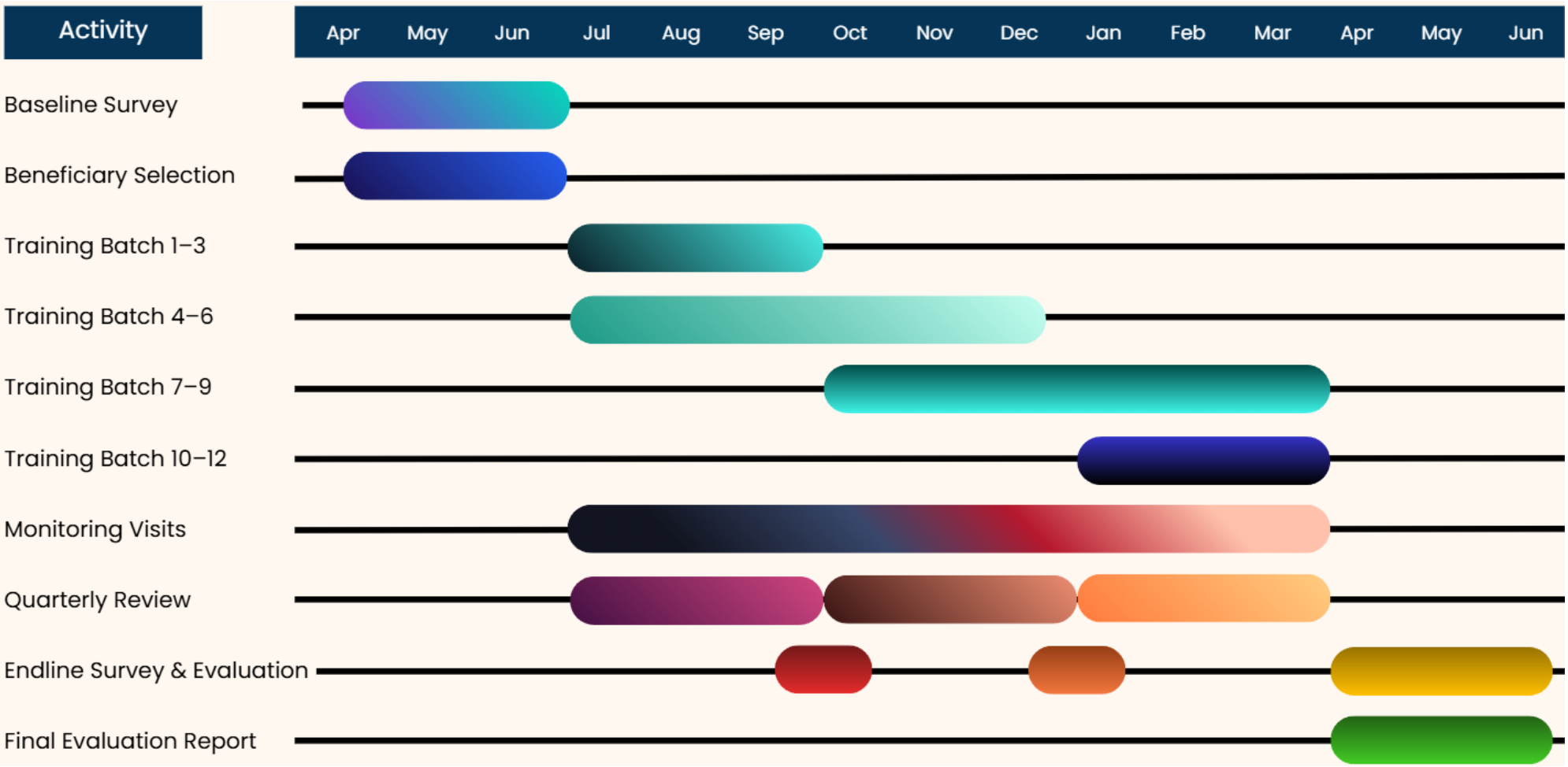
S.No	Budget Component	Cost
7	Monitoring & Evaluation	₹3,30,000
8	Project Personnel	₹10,60,000
9	Administration & Operations	₹1,64,000
10	Documentation & Reporting	₹90,000
11	Contingency	₹3,45,600
	Grand Total	₹38,01,600

The detailed budget will include the following components:

SNo	Component & Item	Cost (₹)	
a)	**Project Mobilization & Beneficiary Selection**		
1	Baseline livelihood survey	₹60,000	
2	Ban Vulnerability Index assessment	₹30,000	
3	Household verification	₹25,000	
4	Community consultations	₹25,000	
5	Beneficiary identification (300 women)	₹20,000	
6	Registration & documentation	₹15,000	
	Subtotal		₹1,75,000
b)	**Training Programme**		
i)	**Training Facilitation**		
7	Master craft trainers	₹2,16,000	
8	Assistant trainers	₹1,08,000	
9	Session facilitation costs	₹40,000	
10	Practical demonstration sessions	₹60,000	
ii)	**Training Logistics**		
11	Training venue rental	₹1,08,000	
12	Electricity and utilities	₹30,000	
13	Training materials and manuals	₹40,000	
14	Audio-visual support	₹25,000	
15	Stationery	₹20,000	
	Subtotal		₹6,47,000
c)	**Training Kits for Participants (x300)**		
16	Hand craft tool kit	₹1,20,000	
17	Cutting tools	₹60,000	
18	Small working mat	₹30,000	
19	Storage pouch	₹30,000	
	Subtotal		₹2,40,000
d)	**Raw Materials for Craft Training**		
20	Marine shells / waste materials	₹80,000	
21	Threads	₹30,000	
22	Adhesives	₹25,000	
23	Paints	₹25,000	
24	Finishing materials	₹30,000	
25	Decorative components	₹20,000	
	Subtotal		₹2,10,000
e)	**Community Production Space**		
26	Worktables	₹40,000	
27	Temporary racks	₹20,000	
28	Storage boxes	₹15,000	
29	Lighting	₹15,000	
	Subtotal		₹90,000
f)	**Participant Support Costs**		

30	Refreshments during training	₹2,70,000	
31	Local Travel Allowance	₹60,00	
32	Participation Stipend	₹1,20,000	
	Subtotal		₹4,50,000
g)	**Monitoring & Evaluation**		
33	Data collection	₹80,000	
34	Beneficiary verification		
35	Baseline data		
36	Monitoring during project phases	₹1,20,000	
37	Endline livelihood survey	₹50,000	
38	Evaluations during project phases	₹80,000	
	Subtotal		₹3,30,000
h)	**Project Personnel**		
39	• Project coordinator	₹4,20,000	
40	• Field mobilizer	₹2,80,000	
41	• Training facilitator	₹2,40,000	
42	• Accounts support	₹1,20,000	
	Subtotal		₹10,60,000
i)	**Administration & Operations**		
43	• Local travel	₹54,000	
44	• Communication	₹30,000	
45	• Printing	₹30,000	
46	• Office expenses	₹50,000	
	Subtotal		₹1,64,000
j)	**Documentation & Reporting**		
47	• CSR progress reports	₹30,000	
48	• Photo documentation	₹20,000	
49	• Case stories	₹10,000	
50	• Final project report	₹30,000	
	Subtotal		₹90,000
k)	**Miscellaneous**		
51	Contingency	₹3,45,600	
	Subtotal		₹3,45,600
	Grand Total	₹38,01,600	

12. Implementation Gantt Chart



13. Monitoring and Evaluation Indicator Matrix

Indicator Type	Indicator	Target	Data Source	Frequency
Input	Training sessions conducted	12 sessions	Training reports	Monthly
Output	Women trained	300	Attendance records	After each batch
Output	Craft products produced	500+ products	Production records	Quarterly
Outcome	Women generating seasonal income	70% of trainees	Income tracking forms	During ban period
Outcome	Average income generated	₹5,000 – ₹10,000 per participant	Sales records	Annual
Impact	Reduction in seasonal borrowing	20% reduction	Household survey	Endline

14. Data Collection and Analysis

The project will employ multiple tools to ensure reliable monitoring.

Data Collection Tools

- Household baseline survey
- Training attendance registers
- Production tracking sheets
- Sales and income logs
- Endline evaluation questionnaires

Data Analysis Methods

- Comparative baseline vs endline analysis
- Income trend analysis
- Beneficiary feedback interviews

All monitoring data will be digitized and maintained by the project team.

15. Reporting and Dissemination Plan

Internal Reporting

- Monthly monitoring reports
- Quarterly project progress reports

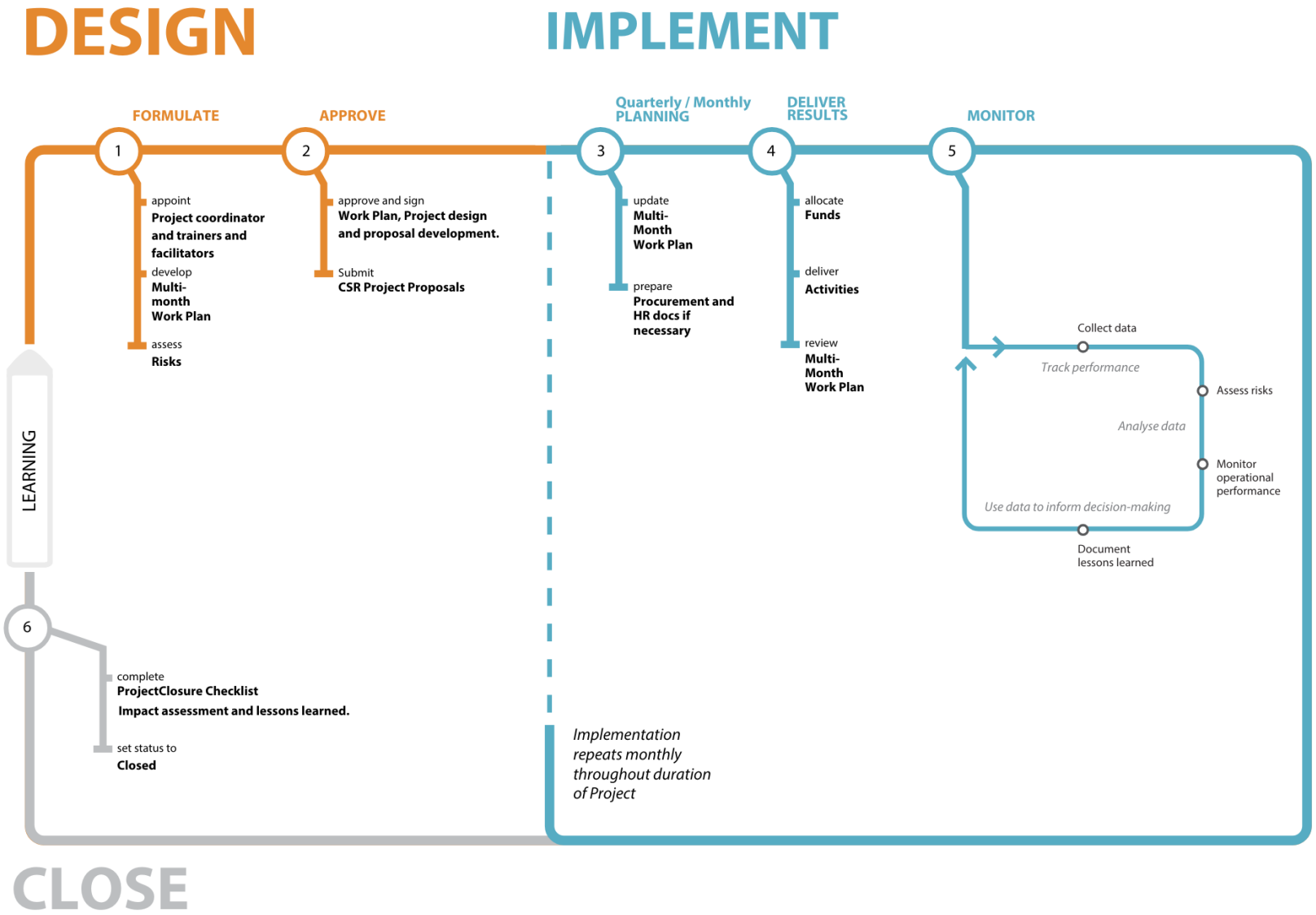
External Reporting

- CSR donor progress updates
- Annual impact report

Knowledge Sharing

- Community meetings
- Case study documentation
- Lessons learned report.

16. Project Cycle



17. Logical Framework Matrix (Logframe)

Level	Description	Indicators	Means of Verification	Assumptions
Impact	Improved seasonal economic resilience of fishing households in Colachel	% reduction in seasonal borrowing during fishing ban	Household surveys, debt tracking records	Fishing ban policy continues annually
Outcome	Women from fishing households generate alternative income during fishing ban period	% beneficiaries generating income during ban period	Income tracking sheets, beneficiary reports	Market demand for craft products remains stable
Output 1	Women trained in marine craft production	Number of women trained (Target: 300)	Training attendance records	Participants complete training
Output 2	Marine craft enterprises initiated	Number of active producers	Production and sales records	Access to raw materials remains available
Output 3	Monitoring and evaluation system implemented	Baseline and endline reports completed	Monitoring reports	Data collection maintained regularly

18. Conclusion

The Women-Led Marine Craft Enterprise Programme aims to strengthen seasonal economic resilience in fishing communities by enabling women to develop alternative livelihood opportunities during the annual fishing ban period.

By combining targeted beneficiary selection, practical skill training, and structured monitoring, the project seeks to create a replicable model for livelihood stabilization in coastal regions affected by seasonal fishing closures.

19. Annexure

Annexure 1

Organizational Compliance Documents

- Trust Registration Certificate
- 12A Certificate
- 80G Certificate
- CSR-1 Registration
- PAN & TAN

Annexure 2

Governance Documents

- Trust Deed
- Board Member Profiles
- Organizational Structure

Annexure 3

Previous Project Reports

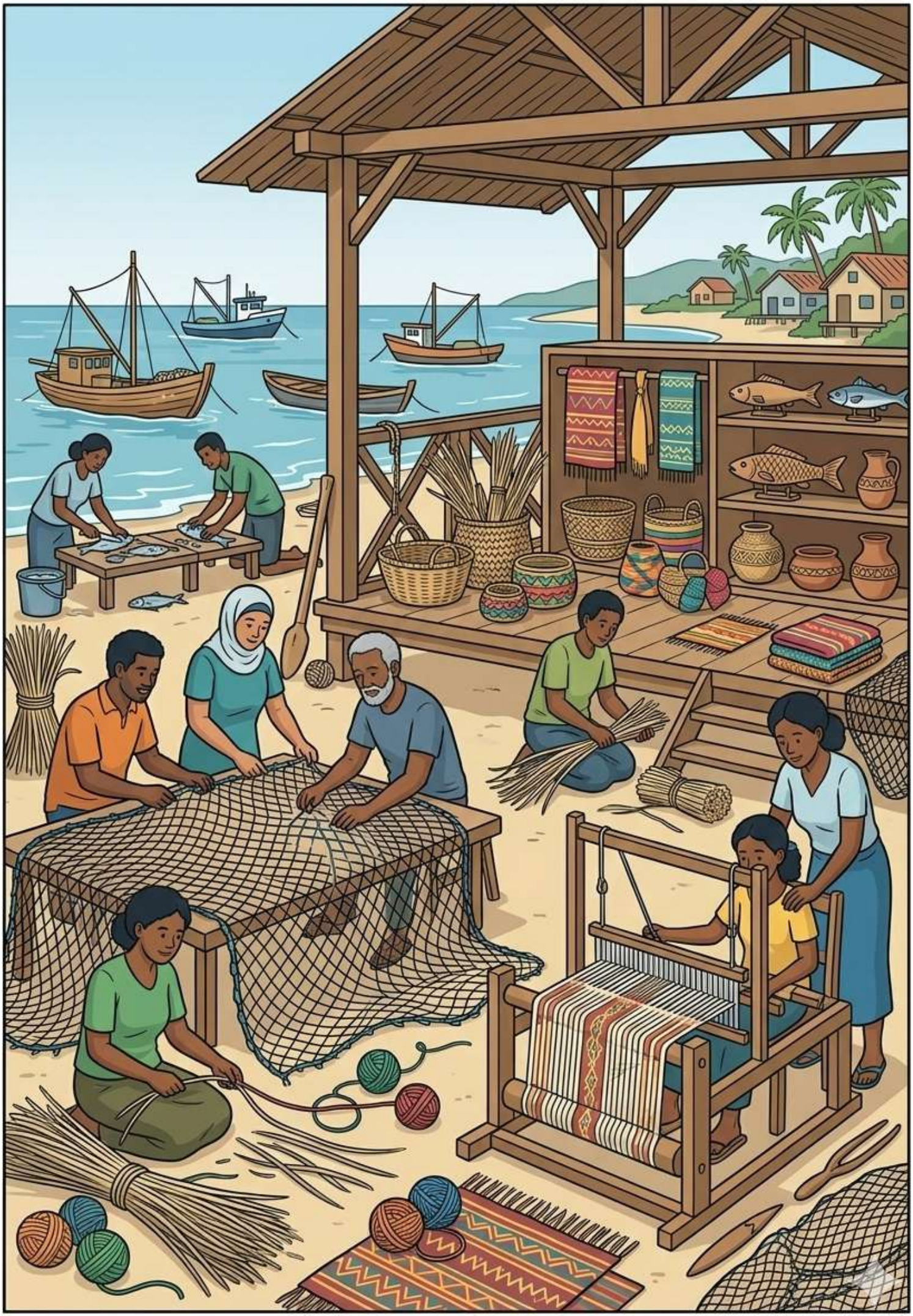
- Marine safety training project
- Women livelihood programs

Annexure 4

Budget explanations

Core Assumptions Used for Budget Estimation

- **Total Beneficiaries:** 300 women
- **Training Structure:** 12 batches
- **Participants per Batch:** 25 women
- **Training Duration:** 6 training days per batch
- **Total Training Days:** 72 trainer-days (12 × 6)
- **Project Duration:** Approximately **14 months** (baseline → training → monitoring → endline)

These assumptions determine trainer fees, logistics, monitoring frequency, and staffing requirements.

Cost per beneficiary:
₹38,01,600 ÷ 300 ≈ **₹12,672 per woman**